

System Hardening Checklist

Operational checklist for Linux security review and closure validation

Domain	Review item	Status in sample	Closure evidence
Accounts	Only authorized UID 0 / sudo users	Pass	UID/group export reviewed
SSH	Root login disabled	Pass	sshd effective config
SSH	Password auth disabled where supported	Pass	sshd effective config + key login
Network	Host firewall active	Pass	Firewall status/rule export
Network	Only required listening services	Pass in sample	Listening-port review
Files	Unexpected world-writable files removed	Pass in assessed paths	find output
Logging	Auth/admin logs retained and forwarded	Needs environment integration	Central search of test event
Patching	Critical updates within SLA	Process requirement	Patch report + exception records
Services	Unused services disabled	Pass in sample	Enabled-service baseline
Scheduled tasks	Cron/system tasks authorized	Pass in sample	Task inventory
Backups	Security configuration backed up	Recommended	Restore validation
Monitoring	Hardening drift detectable	Recommended	Scheduled audit + alert

Use

- Run during initial build, periodic review, and after material configuration changes.
- Record exceptions with owner, reason, compensating control, and expiration date.
- Validate corrective actions with commands or system output rather than ticket status alone.